

Northwind Analytics Finance and Procurement Policy

Purpose and Scope

This Finance and Procurement Policy, reference FIN-2025-01, governs how Northwind Analytics commits to and pays for goods and services. It applies to all employees who request, approve or receive purchases.

The policy is owned by the Chief Financial Officer and is reviewed every 12 months. It does not cover employee expense claims, which are described in the Employee Handbook.

Purchase Approval Thresholds

A purchase order is required for any commitment above 1000 US dollars. Purchases at or below 1000 US dollars may be made on a corporate card without a purchase order.

Commitments up to 10000 US dollars are approved by the budget owner. Commitments from 10000 up to 50000 US dollars require approval from the department Vice President.

Any commitment above 50000 US dollars requires approval from the Chief Financial Officer. Commitments above 250000 US dollars additionally require board notification.

Splitting a single commitment into smaller purchases in order to stay below an approval threshold is a disciplinary matter.

Supplier Onboarding

New suppliers must complete the supplier onboarding form and provide bank details through the verified supplier portal. Bank details are never accepted by email.

A change to existing supplier bank details requires verbal confirmation with a known contact at the supplier using a previously recorded telephone number.

Suppliers processing Restricted data must additionally clear the security review described in the Information Security Policy before a contract is signed.

Invoices and Payment Terms

Standard payment terms are 30 days from the date of a valid invoice. Terms shorter than 30 days require approval from the Chief Financial Officer.

Invoices must quote a valid purchase order number where one was required. Invoices without a purchase order number are returned to the supplier unpaid.

The finance team runs two payment cycles per month, on the 10th and on the 25th.

Disputed invoices must be raised with the finance team within 14 days of receipt.

Corporate Cards

Corporate cards are issued to employees who make recurring purchases on behalf of the company. The default monthly limit is 5000 US dollars.

Card transactions must be reconciled with a receipt within 15 days of the transaction date. Cards with unreconciled transactions older than 45 days are suspended.

Personal use of a corporate card is prohibited, including where the employee intends to

repay the amount.

Travel Booking

All business travel must be booked through the approved travel management company. Direct bookings are reimbursed only where the travel management company was unable to provide an equivalent option.

Travel must be booked at least 14 days in advance where the itinerary is known. Bookings made inside 7 days require manager approval.

Rental cars are limited to intermediate class or below. Ride hailing is preferred for journeys under 50 kilometres.

Budget Management

Budget owners review actual spend against budget monthly. A forecast variance above 10 percent must be explained in the monthly finance review.

Unspent departmental budget does not carry over between financial years. The financial year runs from 1 February to 31 January.